Emmanuel Thabo Sakonta

Independent Cybersecurity Developer | Security Operations & Detection Engineering

Self-directed cybersecurity development and portfolio work | November 2024 – Present | City of Johannesburg, Gauteng, South Africa

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security operations candidate with more than a decade of public-sector Human Resource Management, investigation and compliance experience, now building and documenting a practical, portfolio-based body of cybersecurity work. Since November 2024 I have worked independently across the full analyst workflow: detecting suspicious activity, triaging and investigating alerts and endpoints, hunting for threats, mapping behaviour to MITRE ATT&CK, automating repetitive tasks and communicating findings in clear analyst-style reports.

Targeting SOC Analyst, Cybersecurity Analyst, Detection Engineer and Security Operations roles.

ENGAGEMENT TYPE

This is self-directed cybersecurity development and portfolio work (November 2024 – present), undertaken to build job-ready capability in security operations. It is not formal employment. All projects are lab-based or simulated, and are published through GitHub, a portfolio website and LinkedIn.

ROLE PURPOSE

To design, build, document and maintain practical security operations projects that demonstrate job-ready capability across detection engineering, threat hunting, digital forensics and incident response (DFIR), and security automation.

KEY RESPONSIBILITIES

1. SOC Operations, Alert Triage and Detection Engineering

- Develop detection logic for suspicious PowerShell execution, failed authentication, account creation, privilege escalation and process-creation activity.
- Build KQL-based analytics in Microsoft Sentinel and write Sigma rules for Windows security events.
- Triage and investigate alerts, applying escalation criteria and SIEM investigation techniques.
- Document the detection rationale, investigation methodology and expected analyst response for every rule.

2. Threat Hunting and MITRE ATT&CK

- Conduct hypothesis-driven hunts for brute-force behaviour, suspicious IP activity, privilege escalation and persistence using Bash, Linux log analysis and KQL.
- Analyse network traffic (DNS, HTTP, TCP/IP) in Wireshark to identify suspicious communications.
- Map detections, hunts and findings to MITRE ATT&CK to classify adversary behaviour and communicate detection coverage.
- Produce structured hunt findings and investigation reports.

3. Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR)

- Investigate process, network, file and endpoint artefacts in simulated incident scenarios using Velociraptor DFIR concepts.
- Apply structured evidence collection and analysis to identify suspicious activity and establish scope.
- Prepare investigation reports, executive summaries, evidence documentation and remediation recommendations.

4. Python / Bash Security Automation

- Develop Python and Bash automation for Windows Event Log parsing, event correlation, alert analysis and burst detection.
- Design SOAR playbooks, including a host-isolation playbook with operational guardrails, to demonstrate automated response.
- Build a mini SIEM environment covering log monitoring, file integrity monitoring and event correlation.

5. Security Documentation and Reporting

- Write analyst-style reports, executive summaries and technical documentation for every project.
- Maintain version-controlled projects and documentation using Git and GitHub.
- Publish work through a GitHub repository, portfolio website and LinkedIn profile.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations	Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender concepts, SIEM investigation, alert triage, escalation
Detection & Hunting	KQL, Sigma, MITRE ATT&CK, Windows Event Analysis, IOC investigation
DFIR & Endpoint	Velociraptor concepts, endpoint investigation, evidence collection
Automation & Scripting	Python, Bash, PowerShell, SOAR playbook design
Systems & Version Control	Linux, Windows, Git, GitHub
Network Analysis	Wireshark, DNS, HTTP, TCP/IP
Governance Awareness	POPIA, NIST, ISO 27001

PORTFOLIO DELIVERABLES

- **Microsoft Sentinel Detection Engineering Lab:** KQL analytics and detection documentation in Microsoft Sentinel.
- **Velociraptor Investigation Lab:** endpoint investigation and evidence collection in simulated incidents.
- **Threat Hunting Lab:** hypothesis-driven hunts with ATT&CK mappings and structured findings.
- **Detection Engineering Lab (Sigma):** Sigma rules for Windows security events.
- **Python SOC Automation Lab:** log parsing, correlation, alert analysis and burst detection.
- **SOC Mini SIEM Lab:** log monitoring, file integrity monitoring and event correlation.
- **Network Traffic Analysis Lab and Windows Security Analysis:** Wireshark analysis of DNS, HTTP and TCP/IP traffic, and Windows event analysis.

COMPETENCIES DEMONSTRATED

- Analytical, evidence-based investigation, drawing on more than a decade of public-sector investigation and compliance experience.
- Clear written communication: analyst reports, executive summaries and technical documentation.
- Self-management: planning, scoping and delivering multiple projects independently.
- Governance awareness: POPIA, NIST and ISO 27001.

TRAINING AND QUALIFICATIONS

- **Microsoft SC-200 Security Operations Analyst course, NEMISA (2026):** course completed; preparing for the official Microsoft certification examination.
- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate (2025)**
- **Career Essentials in Cybersecurity, NEMISA (2025)**
- **Cybersecurity Foundations, LinkedIn Learning (2025)**